MASSACHUSETTS

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Pharmacy Medical Policy
Immunomodulators for Skin Conditions

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Policy Number: 010

BCBSA Reference Number: N/A

Related Policies

- Quality Care Dosing guidelines may apply and can be found in Medical Policy #**621B**
- Medical Utilization Management (MED UM) & Pharmacy Prior Authorization Policy - ***Dupixent*** #**033**
- Immune Modulating Drugs– ***Rinvoq*** **#004**

Prior Authorization Information

Policy	☒ Prior Authorization ☒ Step Therapy ☒ Quality Care Dosing ☐ Administrative	**Reviewing Department**	**Pharmacy Operations:** Tel: 1-800-366-7778 Fax: 1-800-583-6289
Policy Last Updated	**5/2026**	**To request for coverage:** Providers may call, fax, or mail the attached form (Formulary Exception/Prior Authorization form) to the address below. **Blue Cross Blue Shield of Massachusetts** **Pharmacy Operations Department** 25 Technology Place Hingham, MA 02043 Tel: 1-800-366-7778 Fax: 1-800-583-6289 **Individual Consideration for the atypical patient:** Policy for requests that do not meet clinical criteria of this policy, see section labeled Individual Consideration	
Pharmacy (Rx) or Medical (MED) benefit coverage	☒ Rx ☐ MED		
Policy applies to Commercial members with BCBSMA formulary: • Managed Care (HMO/POS) • PPO/EPO • Indemnity • MEDEX with Rx plans • Managed Blue for Seniors **Policy does NOT apply to**: • Medicare Advantage			

Provider Documentation Requirements: Documentation from the provider to support a reason preventing trial of formulary alternative(s) must include the name and strength of alternatives tried and failed (if alternatives were tried, including dates if available) and specifics regarding the treatment failure. Documentation to support clinical basis preventing switch to formulary alternative should also provide specifics around clinical reason.
We may also use prescription claims records to establish prior use of formulary alternatives or to show if step therapy criteria has been met. We will require the provider to share additional information when prescription claims

data is either not available or the medication fill history fails to establish use of preferred formulary medications or that step therapy criteria has been met. Other documentation requirements, if any, are outlined in prior authorization criteria.
See Appendix for additional information.

Summary

This is a comprehensive policy covering step therapy, prior authorization and quantity limit requirements for medications used to treat skin conditions.

This policy applies to members utilizing the below medications for the treatment of skin conditions (i.e. atopic dermatitis and alopecia areata). Coverage of medications listed below that are FDA approved for other indications can be found in the related Medical Polices listed above.

Please refer to the chart below for the formulary status/requirements of the medications affected by this policy. See Clinical Criteria section for utilization management criteria.

Drug	Indication(s) Covered in Medical Policy #010	Formulary Status (BCBSMA Commercial Plan)
Adbry *(tralokinumab)*	Atopic dermatitis	NFNC, PA
Cibinqo *(abrocitinib)*	Atopic dermatitis	NFNC, PA
Dupixent *(dupilumab)*	Atopic dermatitis	PA: *See #033 for coverage criteria*
Ebglyss *(lebrikizumab)*	Atopic dermatitis	PA: *See #033 for coverage criteria*
Elidel *(pimecrolimus)*	Atopic dermatitis	ST
Eucrisa (crisaborole)	Atopic dermatitis	ST, QCD
Leqselvi *(deurxolitinib)*	Alopecia Areata	PA, QCD
Litfulo *(ritlecitinib)*	Alopecia Areata	PA, QCD
Olumiant (baricitinib)	Alopecia Areata	NFNC, PA: *See #004 for coverage criteria*
Opzelura *(ruxolitinib)*	Atopic dermatitis	ST, QCD
***Pimecrolimus** topical*	Atopic dermatitis	ST, QCD
Protopic *(tacrolimus)*	Atopic dermatitis	ST
Rinvoq *(upadacitinib)*	Atopic dermatitis	PA
***Tacrolimus** topical*	Atopic dermatitis	ST
Vtama *(tapinarof)*	Atopic dermatitis, Plaque Psorasis	ST
Zoryve cream (*roflumilast)*	Atopic dermatitis, Plaque Psorasis	NFNC, ST
Zoryve foam *(roflumilast)*	Plaque Psoriasis, Seborrheic dermatitis	NFNC, ST
Length of Approval	**12 months**	

Clinical Criteria for Step Therapy Drugs

Step Therapy for Calcineurin Inhibitors, Eucrisa, and Opzelura

Drug	Formulary Status (BCBSMA Commercial Plan)	Step Requirement
Step 1		
Topical corticosteroids	Covered	Covered with no requirements
Step 2		
Eucrisa (crisaborole)	ST, QCD	Requires prior use of ONE step 1 medication OR history of prior use of any step 2 medication in this table within the previous 130 days. See below for prior use criteria.
Opzelura (ruxolitinib)	ST, QCD	
Pimecrolimus Topical	ST, QCD	
Tacrolimus Topical	ST	
Step 3		
Elidel (pimecrolimus)	ST	Requires prior use of TWO step 2 medications OR history of prior use of a step 3 medication in this table within the previous 130 days. See below for prior use criteria.
Protopic (tacrolimus)	ST	

QCD - Quality Care Dosing (quantity limits policy #621B); ST – Step Therapy

Step Therapy for Anzupgo

Drug	Formulary Status (BCBSMA Commercial Plan)	Step Requirement
Step 1		
Topical corticosteroids	Covered	Covered with no requirements
Pimecrolimus Topical	ST, QCD	Covered with step therapy
Tacrolimus Topical	ST	Covered with step therapy
Step 2		
Opzelura (ruxolitinib)	ST, QCD	Covered with step therapy
Step 3		
Anzupgo (delgoctinib)	ST, QCD	Requires prior use of either ONE step 1 **OR** step 2 medication **OR** history of prior use of Anzupgo within the previous 130 days. See below for prior use criteria.

QCD - Quality Care Dosing (quantity limits policy #621B); ST – Step Therapy

Step Therapy for Zoryve Cream and Zoryve Foam

Drug	Formulary Status (BCBSMA Commercial Plan)	Step Requirement
Zoryve Cream (roflumilast)	NFNC, ST	Requires prior use of TWO of any of the following formulary alternatives: topical corticosteroids (e.g desonide lotion, betamethasone lotion), topical calcineurin inhibitors (e.g. tacrolimus ointment, pimecrolimus cream)
Zoryve Foam (roflumilast)	NFNC, ST	Requires prior use of TWO of any of the following formulary alternatives: topical corticosteroids (e.g desonide lotion, betamethasone lotion), topical calcineurin inhibitors (e.g. tacrolimus ointment, pimecrolimus cream), topical antifungals (e.g ketoconazole cream, ciclopirox cream)
NFNC – Non-Formulary Non-Covered; ST – Step Therapy		

Step Therapy for Vtama

Drug	Formulary Status (BCBSMA Commercial Plan)	Step Requirement
Step 1		
Topical corticosteroids	Covered	Covered with no requirements
calcipotriene	Covered, QCD	
calcipotriene - betamethasone	Covered, QCD	
calcipotriene - clobetasol	Covered, QCD	
Step 2		
Vtama (tapinarof)	ST	Requires prior use of TWO step 1 medications OR history of prior use of any step 2 medication in this table within the previous 130 days. See below for prior use criteria.
QCD - Quality Care Dosing (quantity limits policy #621B); ST – Step Therapy		

Clinical Criteria for Prior Authorization Drugs

Biologic Agents for Skin Conditions Table

1. Documented FDA labeled diagnosis, **AND**

2. Meet the step therapy requirements described below.

Drug	Formulary Status (BCBSMA Commercial Plan)	Step Requirement
Dupixent (dupilumab)	PA	PA Required – See Related Policy #033 for coverage criteria
Ebglyss (lebrikizumab)	PA, QCD	PA Required – See Related Policy #033 for coverage criteria
Leqselvi (deurxolitinib)	PA, QCD	PA Required
Litfulo (ritlecitinib**)**	PA, QCD	PA Required
Olumiant (baricitinib)	NFNC, PA, QCD	PA Required – See Related Policy #004 for coverage criteria
Rinvoq (upadacitinib)	PA, QCD	PA Required - see below
Adbry (tralokinumab)	NFNC	Trial of two (2) of the formulary medications above prior to the use of a NFNC medication and confirm diagnosis is within FDA label
Cibinqo (abrocitinib)	NFNC	
QCD - Quality Care Dosing (quantity limits policy #621B); ST – Step Therapy; PA – Prior Authorization; NFNC – Non-formulary Non-covered		

Clinical Coverage Criteria: Adbry, Cibinqo

Adbry (tralokinumab) and **Cibinqo** (abrocitinib) may be covered for moderate to severe atopic dermatitis when **ALL** of the following criteria are met:

1. Confirmed diagnosis of moderate to severe atopic dermatitis

AND

2. Meets BCBSMA Non-Formulary Exception criteria requirements with trial and failure of at least TWO (2) covered formulary alternatives (e.g. Dupixent, Ebglyss, Rinvoq)

Clinical Coverage Criteria: Leqselvi, Litfulo

Leqselvi (deurxolitinib) and **Litfulo** (ritlecitinib**)** may be covered when **ALL** of the following criteria are met:

1. Age according to FDA approval:
   - Equal to or greater than 12 years of age: Litfulo,
   - Equal to or greater than 18 years of age: Leqselvi

AND

2. Confirmed diagnosis of alopecia areata

AND

3. Documentation of ≥50% scalp hair loss

Clinical Coverage Criteria: Rinvoq

Rinvoq (upadacitinib) may be covered when **ALL** of the following criteria are met:

Moderate to Severe Atopic Dermatitis

1. The patient has moderate-to-severe atopic dermatitis (eczema)

AND

2. The patient is 12 years of age or older

AND

3. The patient demonstrated treatment failure with a 14-day trial of a prescription topical corticosteroid **OR** topical calcineurin inhibitors in claims history or previous treatment

AND

4. The drug is prescribed by a board-certified or board-eligible Allergist or Dermatologist

AND

5. Documented Dose and Frequency must be submitted and must be within the FDA approved Dosing and Frequency.

Note: Clinical criteria for all other FDA approved indications can be found in Related Policy #004

Appendix

Forms	To request prior authorization using the Massachusetts Standard Form for Medication Prior Authorization Requests (eForm), click the link below: **https://www.bluecrossma.org/medical-policies/sites/g/files/csphws2091/files/acquiadam-assets/023%20E%20Form%20medication%20prior%20auth%20instruction%20prn.pdf** **OR** **Print and fax, Massachusetts Standard Form for Medication Prior Authorization Requests** #434
Formulary Status	All requests must meet the Step Therapy requirement and for non-covered medications, the member **must** also have had a previous treatment failure with, or contraindication to, **at least two** covered formulary alternatives when available. See section on individual consideration for more information if you require an exception to any of these criteria requirements for an atypical patient
Member cost share consideration	A higher non-preferred cost share may be applied if an exception request is approved for coverage of a non-preferred or a non-formulary/non-covered drug.
Prior Use Criteria	The plan uses prescription claim records to support criteria for prior use within previous 130 days or the trial and failure of formulary alternatives when available. Additional documentation will be required from the provider when historic prescription claim data is either not available or the medication fill history fails to establish criteria for prior use or trial and failure of formulary alternatives. Documentation will also be required to support any clinical reasons preventing the trial and failure of formulary alternatives. Please see the section on documentation requirements for more information.
Individual Consideration (for Atypical Patients)	Our medical policies are written for most people with a given condition. Each policy is based on peer reviewed clinical evidence. We also take into consideration the needs of atypical patient populations and diagnoses.

	If the coverage criteria outlined is unlikely to be clinically effective for the prescribed purpose, the health care provider may request an exception to cover the requested medication based on an individual's unique clinical circumstances. This is also referred to as "individual consideration" or an "exception request." Some reasons why you may need us to make an exception include: therapeutic contraindications; history of adverse effects; expected to be ineffective or likely to cause harm (physical, mental, or adverse reaction). To facilitate a thorough and prompt review of an exception request, we encourage the provider to include additional supporting clinical documentation with their request. This may include: • Clinical notes or supporting clinical statements; • The name and strength of formulary alternatives tried and failed (if alternatives were tried) and specifics regarding the treatment failure, if applicable; • Clinical literature from reputable peer reviewed journals; • References from nationally recognized and approved drug compendia such as American Hospital Formulary Service® Drug Information (AHFS-DI), Lexi-Drug, Clinical Pharmacology, Micromedex or Drugdex®; and • References from consensus documents and/or nationally sanctioned guidelines Providers may call, fax or mail relevant clinical information, including clinical references for individual patient consideration, to: Blue Cross Blue Shield of Massachusetts Pharmacy Operations Department 25 Technology Place Hingham, MA 02043 Phone: 1-800-366-7778 Fax: 1-800-583-6289
Samples	Requests based exclusively on the use of samples will not meet coverage criteria for exception. Additional clinical information demonstrating medical necessity of the desired medication must be submitted by the requesting prescriber for review.
Specialty	Blue Cross Blue Shield of Massachusetts (BCBSMA*) members (other than Medex®; Blue MedicareRx, Medicare Advantage plans that include prescription drug coverage) obtaining the medication from the Pharmacy benefit instead of the Medical benefit will be required to fill their prescriptions for medications listed as specialty at one of the providers in our retail specialty pharmacy network, see link below: Link to Specialty Pharmacy List

Policy History

Date	Action
5/2026	March P&T: Anzupgo added to the policy. Clarified Zoryve cream pre-requisites. Reformatted policy and updated references.
1/2026	Removed oral systemic DMARD requirement for Rinvoq's atopic dermatitis indication. Updated formatting.
11/2025	September P&T: Added Leqselvi to the policy. Also moved Litfulo from Medical Policy #049 to #010 for consistency.
6/2025	Clarified step table for Adbry and Cibinqo ; Added separate pre-requisites for Zoryve Foam due to different indication

2/2025	Added note Ebglyss is in Policy 033.
12/2024	Updated to add Prescriber requirement to Rinvoq for Atopic Dermatitis
10/2024	Added Zoryve foam & Cream as Step 3 in the policy and moved Eucrisa to Step 2 in the respective table.
8/2024	Updated to Remove corticosteroid trial for Rinvoq.
7/2024	Updated Rinvoq criteria to add trial of topical corticosteroid and topical calcineurin inhibitor.
11/2023	Reformatted policy.
9/2023	Reformatted policy. Updated IC section to align with 118E MGL § 51A.
7/2023	Updated to make Systemic table to a two-step and added clarifying language for Rinvoq ®.
8/2022	Updated to add New Table for Topical psoriasis and add Vtama to the policy.
5/2022	Updated to include PA criteria for Rinvoq ®.
4/2022	Updated to consolidate the Biologicals for Atopic Dermatitis into this policy and updated Opzelura ™ to step 2 of the policy
1/2022	Updated to add Opzelura ™ to step 3 of the policy.
4/2020	Updated to remove age edits
1/2019	Updated Cortico-steroid trial time to 2 weeks & Add Generic Elidel® to step 2.
11/2018	Moved Dupixent® to policy 033.
11/2017	Updated to include Dupixent® as step 3 to the policy.
6/2017	Updated address for Pharmacy Operations.
1/2014	Updated ExpressPAth language and remove Blue Value.
11/2011-4/2012	Medical policy ICD 10 remediation: Formatting, editing and coding updates. No changes to policy statements.
11/2011	Reviewed - Medical Policy Group - Plastic Surgery and Dermatology. No changes to policy statements.
5/2011	Reviewed - Medical Policy Group - Pediatrics and Endocrinology. No changes to policy statements.
12/2010	Reviewed - Medical Policy Group - Plastic Surgery and Dermatology. No changes to policy statements.
5/2010	Reviewed - Medical Policy Group - Pediatrics and Endocrinology. No changes to policy statements.
12/2009	Reviewed - Medical Policy Group - Plastic Surgery and Dermatology. No changes to policy statements.
5/2009	Reviewed - Medical Policy Group - Pediatrics and Endocrinology. No changes to policy statements.
12/2008	Reviewed - Medical Policy Group - Plastic Surgery and Dermatology. No changes to policy statements.
5/2008	Reviewed - Medical Policy Group - Pediatrics and Endocrinology. No changes to policy statements.
12/2007	Reviewed - Medical Policy Group - Plastic Surgery and Dermatology. No changes to policy statements.
5/2007	Reviewed - Medical Policy Group - Pediatrics and Endocrinology. No changes to policy statements.
8/2002	New policy, effective 8/2002, describing covered and non-covered indications.

Endnotes and References

1. Anzupgo [package insert]. Dublin, Ireland: LEO Laboratories, Ltd.: 7/2025
2. Based on the recommendation of the BCBSMA Pharmacy and Therapeutics Committee, 2/2002 and updated on P&T recommendations 12/2002.
3. Based on the recommendation of the BCBSMA Pharmacy and Therapeutics Committee and FDA approved indications updated on 5/2005.
4. Litfulo [package insert]. New York, NY: Pfizer, Inc.: 6/2023.
5. Leqselvi [package insert]. Whippany, NJ: Sun Pharmaceutical Industries, Inc. 7/2024.
6. Opzelura [package insert]. Wilmington, DE: Incyte Corporation. 9/2025.

7. Rinvoq [package insert]. North Chicago, IL: AbbVie, Inc. 10/2025.
8. Zoryve [package insert]. Westlake Village, CA: Arcutis Biotherapeutics, Inc. 7/2024.